

2024 HSC English Standard — Paper 1

Marking Guidelines

Section I

Question 1

Criteria	Marks
Explains effectively how Brazil conveys ideas about connection using well-chosen supporting evidence	4
Explains how Brazil conveys ideas about connection using appropriate supporting evidence	3
Describes how Brazil conveys ideas about connection using some supporting evidence	2
Provides some relevant information about the text	1

Sample answer:

Brazil explores the mental connection the speaker has with an absent loved one when in a new place. She wants to share her experiences exploring Venice, 'I want to tell you', where the repetition of the phrase portrays her desire to express her newfound connection to place with someone she knows. The speaker's strong connection to place is further conveyed with the personification of 'how the wood groans' and 'the mist kissed the back of my neck'. This intimate and emotional connection with Venice helps the speaker fill the void and yearning for the loved one who is not present.

Question 2

Criteria	Marks
• Explains effectively how Morton represents the experience of change using well-chosen supporting evidence	4
• Explains how Morton represents the experience of change using appropriate supporting evidence	3
• Describes how Morton represents the experience of change using some supporting evidence	2
• Provides some relevant information about the text	1

Sample answer:

Morton represents the experience of change as a complicated and ongoing process. As Jess prepares for her journey to Australia she has 'readied the house for her absence' and experiences a disconnect from where she has been living. Jess's observations of the different behaviours of people at the airport make her reflect on her own experiences of change. Morton's juxtaposition of Jess's own experiences twenty years earlier with those of 'The young woman' who had an 'eagerness and energy to her gait' creates a tone of nostalgia. This is reflective of her own youthful excitement and the new changes awaiting the young woman.

Question 3

Criteria	Marks
• Explains effectively how Green invites the reader to consider aspects of the human sense of smell using appropriate supporting evidence	3
• Explains how Green invites the reader to consider aspects of the human sense of smell using some supporting evidence	2
• Provides some relevant information about the text	1

Sample answer:

Green invites the reader to consider how smell is the one human sense that cannot yet be replicated or reproduced. He shares a personal anecdote of his virtual reality experience on a roller coaster, describing how the ride 'felt breath-stealingly real' but the inaccurate imitation scent 'wrenched' him from his 'state of joyfully suspended disbelief'. He expands on this point by challenging the reader to consider how humans are unable to accurately imagine and write about smell and 'based on those stories' even AI would get it 'spectacularly wrong'.

Question 4

Criteria	Marks
Analyses effectively how Vincent connects the significance of measurement to human experience using well-chosen supporting evidence	4
Analyses how Vincent connects the significance of measurement to human experience using appropriate supporting evidence	3
Explains how Vincent connects the significance of measurement to human experience with some supporting evidence	2
Provides some relevant information about how Vincent connects the significance of measurement to human experience	1

Sample answer:

Vincent begins with an accumulation of reasons designed to persuade the reader of the importance of measurement to the human experience. This includes figurative phrases like ‘cornerstone of cognition’ and ‘tool of social cohesion and control’ that capture the role it plays in human thought and culture. He further connects its significance to all of humanity through using the plural first person in ‘If we could not measure, then we could not observe the world around us’. Vincent shares a personal anecdote about reporting on the redefinition of the kilogram, then reflects on the transformative nature of his discoveries on his worldview through the simile ‘I felt like I had opened the door of my flat... on to the surface of an alien planet’. Finally, Vincent captures the broad range of human endeavours that are shaped by and connected to measurement through the metaphorical description of it as ‘a banquet of historical, scientific, and sociological wonder’.

Question 5

Criteria	Marks
Compares skilfully how both texts offer a perspective on the ways individuals perceive their surroundings using well-chosen supporting evidence from both texts	5
Compares effectively how both texts offer a perspective on the ways individuals perceive their surroundings using appropriate supporting evidence from both texts	4
Compares how both texts offer a perspective on the ways individuals perceive their surroundings with some supporting evidence	3
Attempts to compare how both texts offer a perspective on the ways individuals perceive their surroundings with limited supporting evidence	2
Provides some relevant information about the text(s)	1

Sample answer:

In *My Name is Lucy Barton*, Strout represents the character's profound engagement with the natural world by using a single run-on sentence to capture a 360-degree perspective of the horizon. In contrast, the photograph suggests that an individual's perspective is filtered by technology, providing an altered version of their surroundings through the blurred landscape in the background and clear focus on the devices in the foreground. These visual choices highlight the ways an individual may have a limited view of the natural world because they are distracted by and over-reliant on technology. By comparison, Strout's narrator makes detailed observations of their home landscape — 'the few trees, the quiet field of cover crops' — which results in their introspective revelation that 'All life amazes me'. Therefore, Strout's prose suggests a spiritual awakening and deep connection to the physical environment, whereas the photograph suggests some individuals' preoccupation with connecting to the world through technology disconnects them from the reality of their surroundings.

Section II

Question 6

Criteria	Marks
- Explains skilfully the ways in which the study of their prescribed text gives them insights into the complex relationship between human qualities, motivations and actions - Presents a perceptive response supported by well-chosen textual references from the prescribed text - Writes a coherent and sustained response using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context	17–20
- Explains effectively the ways in which the study of their prescribed text gives them insights into the complex relationship between human qualities, motivations and actions - Presents a thoughtful response supported by relevant textual references from the prescribed text - Writes an organised response using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context	13–16
- Explains the ways in which the study of their prescribed text gives them insights into the complex relationship between human qualities, motivations and actions - Presents a response supported by some textual references from the prescribed text - Writes a response using variable control of language appropriate to audience, purpose and context	9–12
- Expresses limited understanding of the ways in which the study of their prescribed text gives them insights into the complex relationship between human qualities, motivations and actions - Describes aspects of the prescribed text - Writes a response with limited control of language	5–8
- Refers to the prescribed text in a minimal way - Attempts to compose a response	1–4

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Mapping Grid

Section I

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
1	4	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3
2	4	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3
3	3	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3
4	4	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-1, EN12-3, EN12-5
5	5	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences	EN12-2, EN12-3, EN12-6

Section II

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
6	20	Common Module – Texts and Human Experiences – Prose Fiction – Poetry – Drama – Nonfiction – Film – Media	EN12-1, EN12-3, EN12-5, EN12-7